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Inflorescences in which both racemose and cymose patterns of development occur in a mixed manner. It is of the following two types.

1. Thyrsus: It is a '**Raceme of cymes**'. Indefinite central axis bears lateral pedicellate cymes, (simple or compound dichasia). Example: *Ocimum*, *Anisomeles*.

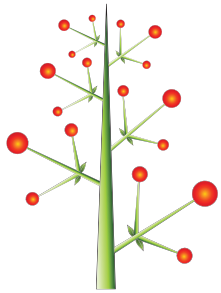




Figure 4.8: (a) diagrammatic, **(b)** Thyrsus

2. Verticil or Verticillaster: Main axis bears two opposite lateral sessile cymes at the axil of the node,each of it produces monochasial scorpioid lateral branches so that flowers are crowded around the node. Example: *Leonotis, Leucas*.

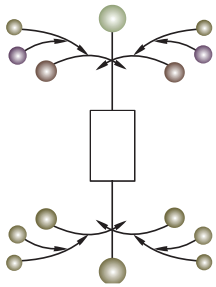




Figure 4.8: (c) diagrammatic,
(d) Verticillaster

IV. Special Inflorescence

The inflorescences do not show any of the development pattern types are classified under special type of inflorescence.

1. Cyathium: Cyathium inflorescence consists of small unisexual flowers enclosed by a common involucre which mimics a single flower. Male flowers are organised in a scorpioid manner. Female flower is solitary and centrally located on a long pedicel. Male flower is represented only by stamens and female flower is represented only by pistil. Cyathium may be actinomorphic (Example: *Euphorbia*) or zygomorphic (Example: *Pedilanthus*.). Nectar is present in involucre.

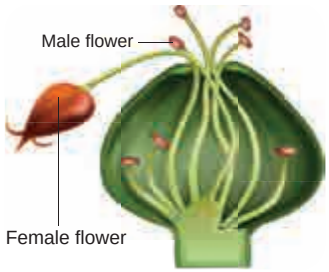




Figure 4.9: (a) diagrammatic,
(b) Cyathium

2. Hypanthodium: Receptacle is a hollow, globose structure consisting unisexual flowers present on the inner wall of the receptacle. Receptacle is closed except a small opening called **ostiole** which is covered by a series of bracts. Male flowers are present nearer to the ostiole, female and neutral flowers are found in a mixed manner from middle below. Example: *Ficus sp*. (Banyan and Pipal).

3. Coenanthium: Circular disc like fleshy open receptacle that bears pistillate flowers at the center and staminate flowers at the periphery. Example: *Dorstenia*



Figure 4.9: (c)
Hypanthodium



Figure 4.9: (d)
Coenanthium